



1. Nehal Shah of India Record Co. says vinyl is a way of preserving an artist's work and keeping it alive
2. For The Record in Panjim is fashioned on vinyl bars in Tokyo

come to buy for themselves or pick up a gift. Thirty per cent of my clientele that comes to the bar has already heard music on vinyl."

While love for vinyl is growing in the country, it is an expensive proposition. On an average a record costs between ₹2,000-3,000. A rare one can even go up to ₹10,000. Then there is the question of the turntable. While the sky is the limit for high-end turntables, amps and speakers, you can get a good turntable for under ₹30,000. This can be connected to any set of speakers with an aux wire. "For those starting out, I recommend a Denon or a Marantz," says Shah. However, if you want the real deal then you need to buy an amp that will push you back further by around ₹60,000. "My advice for anyone getting into the vinyl world is to not buy extremely fancy gear. You can get a full music system, that is, turntable and speakers for within ₹30,000. So even if you have a larger budget, I recommend that you start off with a basic system and focus on building your collection of 50-100 LPs. That will determine if the hobby is going to stay for the long term or not," says de Souza. He further adds that once you know you are in it for the long term, invest around ₹2 lakh for a good system that will last you a lifetime. "The stereo system tech doesn't change."

"It's an expensive hobby but a very satisfying one," says Aneesh Bhasin, Co-founder of artisanal tonic water Svami who has around 100 records. "Hearing it on the vinyl is the closest to hearing someone live. Some albums just sound spectacular on vinyl compared to any other medium." **BT**

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MARKET SIZE WAS \$1.5 BILLION REACH \$2.6 BILLION BY 2025, ACCORDING TO A RESEARCH FIRM IMARC

Raipur, Jodhpur, Bhopal, etc.

Recently the Record Room, a vinyl bar, opened in Bengaluru. Presented by Nakul Bhonsle, Akshar Halgali and Karthik Chandrasekaran, it serves craft beer and has a listening station to cater to both the vinyl connoisseur and the vinyl curious. "The three of us had our respective affairs with vinyl at very different times in our lives. We were collaborating to work on craft beer together. That's when we realised we had this common love for vinyl. And we thought this would add a very interesting layer to the existing craft beer scene in the city," says Chandrasekaran, Co-founder of Record Room. In the past two months since they opened, they have seen a large number of young people come in to enjoy the music. "We see a good range

of young people who are holding a record for the first time in their lives and experiencing the joy of analogue through our listening stations," adds Bhonsle. The Record Room that has a full-time vinyl programme director has a versatile music collection from 1940 to 2020—across genres, from rock to pop, funk, jazz, and blues—and organises events such as vinyl jukebox and 'Bring Your Own Vinyl' to encourage more listeners.

In Goa, Bulund Shukla, an audiophile opened For The Record, a vinyl bar in Panjim in January 2020, fashioned around the vinyl bars of Tokyo, where the focus is on the music and local spirits. He also has a vinyl store which pre-pandemic only catered to foreign tourists. "When I started, people came only for the curiosity factor. Now they